

Model Memory vs Retrieval

Project: Verified Study Buddy

1. Model Memory vs Retrieval

Teach the learning cycle

Primary target: Explain the mechanism and terminology of retrieval and indexing

Session · Sequence and minutes · Resources

Session: Session 1 · Understand · 45 min

Sequence and minutes: 0–7: recall and prerequisite; 7–15: inspect the concrete case and predict; 15–30: teacher models the worked trace; 30–40: learners explain a step using the text and visual; 40–45: check the core idea.

Resources: Sections 1–6; record the brief recall in the workbook.

Session: Session 2 · Practise · 45 min

Sequence and minutes: 0–5: retrieve the procedure; 5–15: W2 completion practice; 15–23: explain and check with a partner; 23–30: each learner answers the misconception check; 30–40: targeted reteaching or a harder variation; 40–45: prepare the investigation.

Resources: Sections 7–10; use the matching workbook W2 and misconception check.

Session: Session 3 · Investigate and transfer · 45 min

Sequence and minutes: 0–5: retrieve the decision rule; 5–20: investigate or trace; 20–30: start the independent case; 30–38: connect the project; 38–43: act on feedback; 43–45: plan the return check.

Resources: Sections 9 and 11–14. Give extra time to finish the full task set; use Section 15 when the week includes a coding lab.

This is a starting allocation of 135 minutes, not a validated duration. Preserve all named topics. Schedule extra time for connected examples, the full investigation, independent cases and project building. Repeated copies of a case share one recorded attempt; they are not new evidence.

Retrieval answer guidance

Verify Numbers and Dates

Without opening the old lesson, explain one key idea from Verify Numbers and Dates. Give an example and a mistake that the idea helps you avoid.

Look for: Explain the mechanism and terminology of claim support and citation evaluation

Reference example, not the only acceptable wording: Teacher explanation: Citation evaluation checks source existence, exact passage support and coverage of answer claims. A real citation can still be irrelevant. For this classroom rubric count a claim as supported only when its cited passage entails it. Separately count correct citation links. Use the number of factual claims as the support denominator.

Hallucination Failure Types

Without opening the old lesson, explain one key idea from Hallucination Failure Types. Give an example and a mistake that the idea helps you avoid.

Look for: Explain the mechanism and terminology of generation failures and verification

Reference example, not the only acceptable wording: Teacher explanation: Generated answers may invent facts, misread quantities or cite irrelevant passages. Verification checks each claim against evidence rather than accepting fluent wording. Split an answer into atomic claims. For each, record the exact source passage, support status and any needed calculation. Mark unsupported and contradicted claims separately; do not repair them by inventing sources.

Visual Composition

Without opening the old lesson, explain one key idea from Visual Composition. Give an example and a mistake that the idea helps you avoid.

Look for: Explain the mechanism and terminology of image generation and provenance

Reference example, not the only acceptable wording: Teacher explanation: An image generator constructs an output from learned patterns and a specification. A generated picture is not a record that the depicted event occurred. Keep a provenance record containing specification, tool/version when known, generation date, edits, permissions and intended use. Label fictional imagery. Inspect visual requirements and avoid inferring identity or event authenticity from appearance.

Use the student module and workbook section with this exact week title. The worked case, independent question and answers below form one aligned lesson sequence.

What the learner must demonstrate

A model states the library opens at 8 from learned patterns. A supplied current notice says 9. Explain the stronger answer and one remaining check.

Concept to explain

Learned parameters are not a searchable source library.

Term · Meaning

Term: parameters

Meaning: Values within a model adjusted during training; distinguish them from settings chosen by a developer.

Term: retrieval

Meaning: Finding and returning existing information from a source or collection.

Term: grounding

Meaning: Connecting an answer or action to specified evidence or observations.

Term: abstain

Meaning: Decline to make a prediction when the available evidence does not meet the decision rule.

Prepare the class

Use the supplied scenario, student illustrations and blank paper. For numeric work, offer counters or a calculator after learners show the setup. Fictional records are supplied; personal data and paid accounts are unnecessary.

Allow 80 minutes: recall 8; explanation 12; worked demonstration 15; guided practice 20; independent assessment 15; project and reflection 10. Extend the lab into a second session when needed.

Preparation for the connected explanation

Two 45-minute sessions. Retrieval returns stored records selected for a query. An index is a searchable representation of a versioned corpus; generated wording is a later operation. Use the supplied constructed scenarios to make the mechanism inspectable. Collect W4 before sharing solutions. Students should name intermediate evidence and limitations; classroom pacing and learning effectiveness remain unvalidated.

Readiness answer

A result depends on the inputs, procedure and conditions that produced it. Preserve data roles and distinguish observed outcomes from predictions or unmeasured conditions. If the prior concept cannot be explained, use a short retrieval activity before this chapter.

Lesson and workbook; paper and pencil

Calculator and optional local Python 3 for arithmetic; no live API or private data

Prepare the fresh retry separately and withhold its solution until after collection

End goal for the pictorial case

By the end, I can explain model memory vs retrieval using a traced example and a stated limitation.

This added worked case illustrates the week's main idea. Retain all original and connected topics; schedule its practice within the teaching cycle.

2. Explain the mechanism

Explain the mechanism

Input → Process → Output

Trace the information. At each stage, ask what changed and how you could test it.

Which stage could fail even when the other two are correct? Explain:

Predict first. Then check each step. A correct answer without visible reasoning is incomplete evidence.

1. Model memory may produce a plausible general explanation.
2. A current date or exact quotation requires retrieval.
3. Arithmetic should be calculated, not guessed from patterns.
4. When source or tool is unavailable, state the limit and abstain.

Recalculate, retrace, or restate the reasoning in your own representation:

CHECK Did the evidence answer the exact question? Did the total, path, or source record stay consistent?

Concrete teaching case

One assistant answers without search; another retrieves a handbook paragraph.

Compare evidence trails.

Exact explanation to model

The first uses learned patterns without an inspected source. The second supplies a passage that can be checked. Retrieval still does not guarantee correct use.

Explain the added worked example

Retrieval returns stored records selected for a query. An index is a searchable representation of a versioned corpus; generated wording is a later operation.

Begin by writing the question the procedure is intended to answer. Identify the information already

supplied, the information it will produce and the information still missing. These are constructed classroom examples; they do not require live accounts, private records or an external service. Do not treat a plausible explanation as a measured outcome.

Assign stable document IDs, versions and permitted access before indexing. Retrieve only authorised records. Preserve source references and define behaviour when a document is missing, outdated or access-restricted.

Before applying the procedure, write its units, denominator or decision boundary where relevant. A partner should be able to repeat each step using the same inputs. If a required input is absent or violates the stated contract, record that condition explicitly instead of quietly replacing it with a convenient value.

Key terms

Term · Meaning

Term: Corpus

Meaning: The collection of records available for a task

Term: Index

Meaning: A searchable representation of that collection

Term: Freshness

Meaning: Whether a record is current for the requested time

Model the reasoning aloud

Use the complete worked example below before asking learners to complete W2. Reveal a small part, invite a prediction, then explain the deciding step. These teacher notes contain solutions; do not reveal the independent case answer during modelling.

Index v1 contains notice N1 for room A. Corpus v2 supersedes it with N2 for room B, but the query still returns N1. What can be reported?

The stale index returns old evidence. It cannot establish current room approval; refresh against authorised corpus v2 or report unresolved freshness.

Compare the intermediate evidence with the final statement. Explain why each number or decision follows from the stated inputs. The conclusion belongs to this scenario and procedure; changing the inputs, evaluation population or authority can change what it establishes. Retain the raw record so a later revision can be compared honestly.

Thinking move · Teacher prompt

Thinking move: Plan

Teacher prompt: What is given? What is the question? Which procedure fits these facts?

Thinking move: Do

Teacher prompt: Point to each input and intermediate step in the worked trace. Name the rule that allows the next step.

Thinking move: Check

Teacher prompt: Does the output answer the question? Which assumption or limitation prevents a larger claim?

Use the diagram and verbal explanation together. Ask learners to match a sentence to a specific visual step; do not assign learners fixed visual or auditory learning styles.

A pictorial worked case: Model Memory vs Retrieval

The library assistant remembers an old opening time, but a current notice can be retrieved.

The facts we will use

Approved notice LIB-v = 2 says Wednesday closes at 16: 00; the model previously produced 15: 00. The question asks the current Wednesday closing time.

All inputs and outcomes in this worked example are invented classroom data; no real model run is claimed.

Model Memory vs Retrieval

Start with the supplied facts

Follow each arrow. Ask which fact allows the next step.



1. Old guess

A remembered-looking answer says 15: 00; no current notice is attached.



2. Find notice

Retrieve authorised LIB-v = 2, which explicitly says Wednesday closes at 16: 00.



3. Ground answer

Answer 16: 00 and attach LIB-v = 2. Its words, rather than the earlier guess, support this claim.

CHANGE ONE THING

LIB-v = 2 is unavailable.

Explain the changed result using the matching lesson.

Read the picture one step at a time

Step · What happens and why

Step: 1. Old guess

What happens and why: A remembered-looking answer says 15: 00; no current notice is attached.

Step: 2. Find notice

What happens and why: Retrieve authorised LIB-v = 2, which explicitly says Wednesday closes at 16: 00.

Step: 3. Ground answer

What happens and why: Answer 16: 00 and attach LIB-v = 2. Its words, rather than the earlier guess, support this claim.

Match each pictured step to the supplied facts. This is a worked teaching case, not an independent assessment.

Why this result follows

Read the picture in order. Answer 16: 00 and attach LIB-v = 2. Its words, rather than the earlier guess, support this claim. The arrows show which recorded input or intermediate result each decision uses. Explain the deciding step aloud before checking the changed case; pointing to the final answer alone does not show how it follows.

What this example does not establish

A retrieved document can itself be wrong or outdated; source approval, date and scope still need checking.

Change one thing in the pictured case

Change: LIB-v = 2 is unavailable.

Prediction: Report that the current time cannot be verified.

Reason: The unsupported old guess does not become current evidence when retrieval fails.

Ask while showing the picture

Cover the result. Ask learners to name the inputs and predict the next step. Uncover one step, connect the icon to the actual procedure, and explain its evidence. Then change the supplied condition and compare. The picture is a representation; it does not document execution of a real AI model.

3. Demonstrate and guide practice

Demonstrate and guide practice

Board sequence

Write the given facts: One assistant answers without search; another retrieves a handbook paragraph.

Write the question to explain: Compare evidence trails.

Reveal after predictions: The first uses learned patterns without an inspected source. The second supplies a passage that can be checked. Retrieval still does not guarantee correct use.

Keep for an independent attempt: A model recalls last year's opening hours; a retrieved current notice gives different hours. How should the answer use this evidence?

Classroom dialogue

Ask: Which facts are given, and which would we have to assume? Learners mark relevant details before discussing answers.

Say: Predict first. Show the rule, information path or calculation that would produce the result. A correct guess is not yet an explanation.

Reveal reasoning one step at a time. Explain why a tempting alternative fails. Write units and denominators for arithmetic, trace conditions for decisions, and identify supporting sources for claims.

In pairs, one learner solves while the other checks evidence; exchange roles. Remove the worked answer before independent assessment.

Model these guided questions

Guided: The stale index returns old evidence. It cannot establish current room approval; refresh against authorised corpus v2 or report unresolved freshness. Qualification: High retrieval similarity does not override permissions or make an obsolete source current. Exit: accept a concrete variation with its predicted outcome and a stated condition that would challenge the mechanism; reject a claim resting on unmeasured evidence.

Case-specific teaching sequence

Stage · Teacher action

Stage: Session 1: 0–7 minutes

Teacher action: Retrieve the prerequisite; identify the input, procedure and evidence source.

Stage: 7–18 minutes

Teacher action: Explain section 1 and vocabulary. Complete W1 with a mechanism-based explanation.

Stage: 18–32 minutes

Teacher action: Trace the declared procedure and worked case. Complete W2, recording intermediate steps.

Stage: 32–45 minutes

Teacher action: Discuss the diagram with the worked input; use W3 to distinguish measured claims and limitations.

Stage: Session 2: 0–8 minutes

Teacher action: Retrieve the worked reasoning and collect the guided response before discussing it.

Stage: 8–20 minutes

Teacher action: Compare a proposed boundary variant with the original case; identify what remains fixed.

Stage: 20–35 minutes

Teacher action: Collect W4 independently. Require the procedure trace and the bounded conclusion.

Stage: 35–45 minutes

Teacher action: Use W5 and exit responses for feedback. Administer the fresh retry after feedback and preserve both attempts.

Reduce help deliberately

Completion task: Index v1 contains notice N1 for room A. Corpus v2 supersedes it with N2 for room B, but the query still returns N1. What can be reported? Show the intermediate steps and give the conclusion with its scope.

Teacher check: Teacher explanation: The stale index returns old evidence. It cannot establish current room approval; refresh against authorised corpus v2 or report unresolved freshness.

Start by identifying the given inputs together. Leave the intermediate steps blank. If needed, model one step, then withdraw that help on the next step. Move to a full trace only when the partial trace is understood. For partners, alternate explainer and checker; collect a response from every learner before discussion.

Individual reasoning check

Use the worked case for Retrieval and indexing. Proposed explanation: “The worked result establishes every future case”. Decide whether this explanation is supported. Point to the step or supplied fact that decides; explain your repair if needed.

Expected correction: High retrieval similarity does not override permissions or make an obsolete source current.

Collect explanations, not only yes/no votes. If a misunderstanding is common, re-model the relevant step for the class. If it affects a few learners, give a short targeted group explanation while others solve a more demanding variation.

Pictorial practice question

Why can the assistant not certify 15: 00 when the notice is missing? Point to the relevant step in the picture, then write the changed result and the rule or evidence that supports it.

Reasoned teacher answer

15: 00 came from an unsupported earlier output. Missing current evidence requires an uncertainty statement, not substitution. Changed-case check: Report that the current time cannot be verified. The unsupported old guess does not become current evidence when retrieval fails.

Changed-case reasoning: Report that the current time cannot be verified. The unsupported old guess does not become current evidence when retrieval fails.

Collect each learner's explanation before discussion. Use the first missing connection between input, deciding step and result to choose support. This question is worked-case practice, not fresh mastery evidence.

4. Run the weekly evidence lab

Run the weekly evidence lab

Words You Can Use to Reason

A definition matters when you can recognize the idea, use it, and contrast it with a near-miss.

Predict → Test → Record → Explain

Keep expected and actual results separate. Surprises are useful data when recorded honestly.

Route twelve questions to model, retrieval, calculator, or abstain; defend the evidence requirement for each.

What did the hardest test teach you that the normal test did not?

Make the lab runnable

Use the concrete case as the shared normal case and the independent question as a second case. Each pair creates a boundary or missing-information case and predicts its result before testing. Keep the expected result separate from an observed mistake.

Record · What to capture

Record: Input or evidence

What to capture: Exact data, instruction or claim

Record: Expected result

What to capture: Answer or safe fallback declared before the run

Record: Observed result

What to capture: Actual result, including errors

Record: Explanation

What to capture: Rule, calculation or evidence explaining the outcome

Record: Next test

What to capture: One justified change and a new prediction

Diagnose and reteach

For guessing, return to given facts and request a trace. For vocabulary without application, use one example and one non-example. For arithmetic errors, check the setup before the calculation. Finish with a different uncoached case before recording mastery.

Address these additional misconceptions

The worked result establishes every future case: High retrieval similarity does not override permissions or make an obsolete source current.

A missing input may be replaced without recording the change: A replacement changes the evidence or contract. Record the change and its justification; do not silently turn unknown into a measured value.

Repeating an assessed case is new independent evidence: A replay checks consistency. An example used for feedback or revision cannot later be described as untouched final evaluation.

Match the support to the first error

What the response shows · Next teaching action

What the response shows: Missing or misread facts

Next teaching action: Read the case aloud, mark supplied versus unknown facts, and let the learner restate it.

What the response shows: Wrong procedure

Next teaching action: Return to the deciding step in the worked case. Contrast it with the proposed incorrect explanation.

What the response shows: Arithmetic or implementation error

Next teaching action: Trace intermediate values or lines; preserve the first mismatch and retry that step.

What the response shows: Correct result without a reason

Next teaching action: Ask for a trace and a changed case before marking independent understanding.

What the response shows: An unsupported wider claim

Next teaching action: Ask which supplied evidence supports the claim and which further observation would be needed.

Offer an oral explanation, drawing, enlarged visual or fewer examples when that removes a reading/writing barrier. Keep the same reasoning goal. Stretch secure learners by changing a boundary or assumption and asking them to defend the effect, not simply by assigning more of the same questions.

5. Assess and explain the answers

Assess and explain the answers

Worked case answer

The first uses learned patterns without an inspected source. The second supplies a passage that can be checked. Retrieval still does not guarantee correct use.

Independent question

A model recalls last year's opening hours; a retrieved current notice gives different hours. How should the answer use this evidence?

Expected independent answer

Use the relevant current notice, cite it and identify its date. Model recall is not a substitute for checking information that changes.

What counts as evidence

Criterion · 0 points · 1 point · 2 points

Criterion: Result

0 points: Incorrect or absent

1 point: Partly correct

2 points: Correct with necessary conditions

Criterion: Reasoning

0 points: No supporting trace

1 point: Some steps

2 points: Clear mechanism, calculation or source support

Criterion: Limit

0 points: Overclaims certainty

1 point: Vague limitation

2 points: Relevant uncertainty or missing fact

Criterion: Transfer

0 points: Copies without adapting

1 point: Adapts with prompts

2 points: Solves a changed case independently

Use 6/8 as a classroom checkpoint, with 2 required for both Result and Reasoning. This is a proposed teaching rule, not a validated certification threshold. Do not count a coached answer as independent mastery; correct unsafe or unsupported claims regardless of total.

Feedback

Ask the learner to find the evidence that challenges this claim: “A model's confident memory always outranks a current primary source.” Keep the first attempt and an uncoached retry separate.

Original transfer answer

Answer 9 with the notice as support, after confirming the branch and date. Learned patterns are not an inspected current record. Retrieval helps provide evidence but the system can still retrieve or interpret the wrong passage.

Explanations for the additional workbook examples

W1 Explain the mechanism

Explain the weekly mechanism in your own words. Use the worked scenario to name its input, decision rule and output.

Teacher explanation: Retrieval returns stored records selected for a query. An index is a searchable representation of a versioned corpus; generated wording is a later operation. Assign stable document IDs, versions and permitted access before indexing. Retrieve only authorised records. Preserve source references and define behaviour when a document is missing, outdated or access-restricted.

W2 Trace the worked case

Index v1 contains notice N1 for room A. Corpus v2 supersedes it with N2 for room B, but the query still returns N1. What can be reported? Show the intermediate steps and give the conclusion with its scope.

Teacher explanation: The stale index returns old evidence. It cannot establish current room approval; refresh against authorised corpus v2 or report unresolved freshness.

W3 Audit the limit

A report omits this qualification: High retrieval similarity does not override permissions or make an obsolete source current. Explain how omitting it could change a reader's interpretation, and write an accurate replacement.

Teacher explanation: High retrieval similarity does not override permissions or make an obsolete source current. State the observed result separately from the unverified or out-of-scope claim; preserve the original evidence rather than inventing a missing fact.

W4 Apply a new case independently

Corpus has public P, teacher-only T and withdrawn W. A student search returns all three. Identify the filtering defect and whether hiding T after generation is sufficient.

Teacher explanation: Filter authorisation and active status before evidence reaches the student generation path: P only. Hiding a final citation does not undo exposed teacher content.

W5 Design a revealing follow-up

For the worked scenario, propose one additional case that could reveal a failure, describe its expected outcome before running it, and explain what would need to remain fixed for a fair comparison. Do not reuse W4 as a new final test after receiving feedback.

Teacher explanation: Accept a concrete variant of the worked input or a missing/conflicting/boundary condition, with an expectation derived from the declared procedure. Require preserved settings, original outputs and data roles. High retrieval similarity does not override permissions or make an obsolete source current. The new case should test this particular mechanism rather than merely restate the original result.

Assess independent transfer

Selected case: Corpus has public P, teacher-only T and withdrawn W. A student search returns all three. Identify the filtering defect and whether hiding T after generation is sufficient.

Selected case answer

Teacher explanation: Filter authorisation and active status before evidence reaches the student generation path: P only. Hiding a final citation does not undo exposed teacher content.

Dimension · Evidence required

Dimension: Explanation

Evidence required: Names the applicable idea or procedure and ties it to the supplied facts.

Dimension: Trace and result

Evidence required: Preserves the given inputs and shows the relevant intermediate steps; distinguishes a prediction from an observed execution.

Dimension: Limits

Evidence required: States the assumptions, missing evidence or conditions under which the result would change.

Record each dimension as not yet, with support, or independent. Accept a valid alternative procedure with a defensible trace. Do not penalise an honestly recorded model failure if the learner correctly explains its evidence and limits.

Feedback that the learner uses

Name the earliest unsupported step and give one action to repair it. Have the learner make that repair now and explain why. Then assess the relevant skill on a fresh, fully specified case. Confirm it was not previously practised with feedback; solve and check the new case before assigning it. A follow-up design prompt is a starting brief, not automatically an equivalent test.

6. Connect and extend learning

Connect and extend learning

Verified Study Buddy

The Study Buddy retrieves course passages and never presents model memory as a citation.

Keep the decision, input, result, explanation and remaining limitation in the project evidence record.

Retrieve this record next week rather than restarting the project.

Support and stretch

Provide one short approved passage; separate instruction, input, output and evidence. Stretch: introduce an unsupported claim or conflicting source and validate claim by claim with a fallback.

Exit reflection

Ask for one decision the learner can now justify and one situation requiring more evidence or human review. Confidence ratings are separate from correct independent performance.

Bridge to the next week

Next: Week 18: Retrieval-Augmented Generation. Retrieve today's evidence and identify what carries forward and what is new.

Support and fresh reassessment

Provide an input/procedure/result/limit frame and a calculator when needed. Ask students to identify the first step before completing the whole trace. Extension: compare two concrete variants of this mechanism while holding unrelated conditions fixed; report both successful and unsuccessful outcomes.

W4: Filter authorisation and active status before evidence reaches the student generation path: P only. Hiding a final citation does not undo exposed teacher content. Require intermediate reasoning and the stated scope. Fresh retry: Student corpus has authorised A, restricted B and expired C. Select eligible indexed evidence. Expected reasoning: A only; apply access and active-version filters before retrieval results enter the response context. If students need support, record it and reassess with another new case rather than awarding independence to a copied answer.

Next connection: Chunking and document structure. Preserve the current case record and retrieve its evidence boundary before moving on.

Plan the delayed return

Suggested return points in this level: ai-3/18, ai-3/20, ai-3/23. Use actual classroom dates, adjusting for holidays and gaps. One, three and six teaching weeks are scheduling choices, not a claimed optimal spacing.

At a delayed check, ask for the idea from memory and a changed application. Compare with the earlier independent response and record support used. For a new level, revisit the previous capstone before checking the new prerequisites.

Record - Teacher evidence

Record: Learner code and date

Teacher evidence: _____

Record: Concept and case used; prior exposure

Teacher evidence: _____

Record: Explanation / trace / limits

Teacher evidence: _____

Record: Support and first repair

Teacher evidence: _____

Record: Changed case and delayed outcome

Teacher evidence: _____

Record: Next teaching action

Teacher evidence: _____

Use the evidence to choose reteaching or the next step. A completed page, confidence rating or attractive project does not by itself demonstrate understanding.

Project evidence from this case

For your Verified Study Buddy, save the input, procedure, observed result and limitation of this check. Label this worked example as practice; use a different, previously unreviewed case when checking independent understanding.